

The Constitution of the Student Government Association of Stevens Institute of Technology



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Contents

Article I	The Student Government Association	4
Article II	The Legislative Branch	5
Section 2.1	Membership	5
Section 2.2	Sessions of the Senate	5
Section 2.3	Reduced and Full Session	5
Section 2.4	Meetings	6
Section 2.5	Powers and Responsibilities	6
Section 2.6	Parliamentarian	7
Article III	The Executive Branch	8
Section 3.1	Membership	8
Section 3.2	Elections and Appointments	8
Section 3.3	Meetings	8
Section 3.4	Line of Succession and Vacancies	8
Section 3.5	President	9
Section 3.6	Vice-President of Operations	9
Section 3.7	Vice-President Of Academic Affairs	9
Section 3.8	Vice-President of Finance	10
Section 3.9	Vice-President of Student Interests	10
Section 3.10	Vice-President of Relations	10
Section 3.11	Secretary	11
Article IV	Oversight/Impeachment	12
Section 4.1	Oversight Committee	12
Section 4.2	Initial Proceedings & Disciplinary Actions	12
Section 4.3	Impeachment Proceedings	13
Section 4.4	Appeal Impeachment Trial	14
Article V	Recognized Student Organizations	15
Section 5.1	Definition	15
Section 5.2	Policies	15
Article VI	Elections	16
Section 6.1	Senator Elections	16

Section 6.2	Senator Vacancy Elections	17
Section 6.3	Tied Senator Elections	18
Section 6.4	Presidential Elections	18
Section 6.5	Conflict of Interest	19
Section 6.6	Election Rules	19
Section 6.7	Violations and Enforcement	20
Article VII Bylaws		21
Article VIII Amendment of this Constitution		22
Article IX Adoption		23

1 We, the undergraduate students of Stevens Institute of Technology, in order to provide
 2 ourselves with a representative system of governance, promote student-centricity at this
 3 Institute, and establish formal channels of communication between ourselves and the
 4 administration of this Institute, do hereby adopt the following constitution. *Per Aspera*
 5 *Ad Astra*.

Article I. The Student Government Association

There shall be an organization named the Student Government Association of Stevens Institute of Technology, herein referred to as the "SGA." The SGA shall promote the welfare of the enrolled undergraduate students of Stevens Institute of Technology, herein referred to as the "Student Body," and Stevens Institute of Technology, herein referred to as the "Institute," as a whole. The SGA shall govern the Student Body and represent its interests. The SGA shall have at least one faculty or staff advisor, herein referred to as the "SGA Advisor" whose responsibilities are outlined within the governing documents.

All members of the Student Body shall be considered members of the SGA. All members of the Student Body who have been elected or appointed to positions of the SGA shall be called "Officials of the SGA." Only members of the Student Body shall be eligible for these positions. No member of the Student Body with a cumulative Grade Point Average of less than a 2.5 shall seek, be appointed to, or maintain a position as part of the Officials of the SGA. Unless specified otherwise, no member of the Student Body shall hold more than one of the positions noted as an Official of the SGA.

All members of the Student Body shall pay a Student Activity Fee to the Institute as determined by the Institute in conjunction with the SGA, which shall be delegated to the SGA for allocation. The Student Activity Fee shall fall equally on each member of the Student Body each semester. The SGA shall have the power, within its own means, to recommend a change in the amount of the Student Activity Fee.

Article II. The Legislative Branch

There shall be a Senate of the Student Government Association, a deliberative assembly whose membership, powers, and responsibilities are defined herein. A Senator is an elected representative of the Student Body. Senators are responsible for and have a duty to represent the interests of their respective constituents. Senators function as equals and have no authority over one another except in the positions outlined in the governing documents of the SGA.

Section 2.1. Membership

The Senate shall have one seat for every seventy-five (75) students. The number of seats shall be determined by following standard rounding rules. These seats shall be divided between a quantity of “by-School” seats and a quantity of “at-Large” seats. Each school shall have one Senate seat for every one-hundred (100) students enrolled in that school as of the first day of classes of that academic year. The number of seats shall be determined by rounding to the next full hundred. Should a School consist of fewer than one hundred (100) students, it shall have one Senate seat. The remainder of the seats will be assigned the classification of “at-Large” seats.

Section 2.2. Sessions of the Senate

The session of a particular Senate shall begin at the start of the Senate meeting following the conclusion of the General Senator Elections period held within the first month of the fall semester, and end at the start of the next session of the Senate. A session of the Senate shall be defined separately from the Senate’s parliamentary session.

Each session of the Senate shall be numbered, beginning with the first session of the Student Council in April 1913. The Senate of the 2025-2026 academic year shall be the one hundred and eleventh (112th) Senate.

Section 2.3. Reduced and Full Session

During any period in which either classes are not to be held for more than one week or less than half of the Student Body is enrolled in classes, and the Senate is not in recess, the Senate shall be considered to be “in reduced session.” Attendance at any Senate meeting shall not be mandatory while the Senate is in reduced session.

The Senate shall be considered “in full session,” or simply “in session,” at any time that it is neither in recess nor reduced session.

Section 2.4. Meetings

The Senate shall meet at least once each week while it is in session. Any Senate meeting must either be regularly scheduled as resolved by the Senate, or announced at least three days prior by the Secretary. Two-thirds of Senators shall constitute quorum of the Senate.

Senate meetings shall be open to the Student Body. The minutes of Senate meetings shall be made publicly available to the Student Body before the start of the next Senate meeting.

Section 2.5. Powers and Responsibilities

The Senate shall have the authority to grant the status of Recognized Student Organization to any organization that petitions the Senate for recognition whose constitution does not conflict with the governing documents of the SGA and declared purpose is not indistinguishable from the purpose of any existing Recognized Student Organization, as determined by the Senate.

The Senate shall have the power to revoke the status of a Recognized Student Organization that has either failed to appropriately manage its funding or does not comply with its own constitution, the governing documents of the SGA, Institute policy, or any applicable local, state, or federal laws.

The Senate shall elect a Speaker to chair meetings of the Senate, who may or may not be a Senator, using a plurality voting system. In the circumstance that a Senator is elected as Speaker, they shall abstain from voting on any business unless the Senate is equally divided or when not presiding in cases of impeachment trials.

The Senate shall have the authority to override Presidential vetoes by way of a two-thirds affirmative vote. Furthermore, the Senate shall have the authority to overturn the Vice-President of Operations’ decision to form an ad-hoc committee by way of a two-thirds affirmative vote.

The Senate shall have the authority to form its own standing and ad-hoc committees whose membership may include any member of the Student Body. A standing committee must have its definition specified in the Bylaws.

The Senate shall have the authority to approve Cabinet appointments by way of a two-thirds affirmative vote.

The Senate shall have the authority to declare, due to circumstances in which holding regular meetings and conducting business are not viable, a period in which it shall be considered “in recess,” by way of a two-thirds affirmative vote. While in recess, no business may be conducted nor meetings held by the Senate, except that a meeting may be held to consider a resolution to come back from recess ahead of schedule. The Senate

94 may not declare itself in recess for a period which outlasts the current session of the
95 Senate.

96 **Section 2.6. Parliamentarian**

97 Constitutional oversight of SGA proceedings shall be the responsibility of a Parliamen-
98 tarian of the SGA. The Parliamentarian shall have the right to review the constitution-
99 ality of all motions brought before the Senate prior to or during their discussion. The
100 Parliamentarian shall not have the power to mandate that a motion to be rescinded.
101 The term for a Parliamentarian shall align with the Session of the Senate. It shall be
102 the responsibility of the President to nominate a Parliamentarian within the next two
103 Senate meetings after the position is declared vacant, and the Senate shall approve the
104 Parliamentarian nomination via a two-thirds affirmative vote. Anyone in the Student
105 Body may be elected to the position of Parliamentarian. Should a Senator be elected
106 as the Parliamentarian, they must resign from the Senate within 48 hours of their ap-
107 pointment to the position of Parliamentarian. The Parliamentarian shall be required
108 to attend all Meetings of the Senate, provided however, that they may accrue up to
109 two absences per academic semester. If they are unable to attend a meeting, they must
110 provide written notice to the Secretary at least 24 hours prior to the beginning of the
111 meeting. If the Parliamentarian arrives after the beginning of a meeting or leaves prior
112 to its completion, then they shall accrue half an absence.

Article III. The Executive Branch

There shall be a President of the SGA, who shall act as the official representative of the Student Body, and a Cabinet of the SGA, an administrative body which shall be responsible for performing duties assigned by the President relevant to its positions. The President and Cabinet shall have the responsibility to promote the welfare of the Student Body by administrative means.

Section 3.1. Membership

The Executive Branch shall consist of the President and the Cabinet. The Cabinet shall consist of the Vice-President of Operations, Vice-President of Academic Affairs, Vice-President of Finance, Vice-President of Student Interests, Vice-President of Relations, and Secretary.

No person who has not been enrolled at least two consecutive semesters at the Institute shall be President or Vice-President of Operations.

Section 3.2. Elections and Appointments

The President-elect shall make an appointment to each Cabinet position, with the exception of Vice-President of Operations, between being notified of the results of the Presidential election and taking office.

The President and Cabinet shall assume office at 8:00 AM EST on the first day of classes of the spring semester following the Presidential election.

Section 3.3. Meetings

The Cabinet shall meet at least once each week while the Senate is in session, as well as at the request of the President. The President shall act as the chair of these meetings.

Section 3.4. Line of Succession and Vacancies

In the event of a vacancy of the position of President, the Vice-President of Operations shall assume the position of President, and the Speaker shall assume the position of Vice-President of Operations pending the election of a new Speaker. In the event of a vacancy of the position of Vice-President of Operations, the Speaker shall assume the

position of Vice-President of Operations pending the election of a new Speaker. In the event of a vacancy of a Cabinet position other than Vice-President of Operations, the President shall make a new appointment to the vacant Cabinet position.

Section 3.5. President

The President shall have the responsibility to act as the official representative of the Student Body.

The President shall have the responsibility to sign or veto legislation passed by the Senate. A veto may only be done if the President states the reasons for the veto in written form and makes them available to the Senate within three days after the piece of legislation in question has been passed. Presidential vetoes may be overridden by way of a two-thirds affirmative vote of the Senate. Failure by the President to sign a piece of legislation passed by the Senate shall be considered as an implicit veto.

The President shall have the authority to act as the chair of meetings of the Cabinet. The President shall have the authority to call unscheduled meetings of the Cabinet in the case of an emergency.

The President shall have the authority to call unscheduled meetings of the Senate in the case of an emergency, except when the Senate is in recess.

Section 3.6. Vice-President of Operations

The Vice-President of Operations shall have the responsibility to perform all duties of the President in the absence of the latter.

The Vice-President of Operations shall have the responsibility to act as the liaison between the Senate and the Cabinet.

Unless otherwise specified, the Vice-President of Operations shall have the authority to appoint the chairs of all standing and ad-hoc committees of the Senate, which shall be approved by way of a two-thirds affirmative vote of the Senate, with the exception of standing and ad-hoc committees which have an otherwise specified chair in the governing documents of the SGA.

The Vice-President of Operations shall have the authority to form ad-hoc committees of the Senate. The Vice-President of Operations' decision to form an ad-hoc committee may be overturned by way of a two-thirds affirmative vote of the Senate.

The Vice-President of Operations shall have the responsibility to oversee the activities of all standing and ad-hoc committees of the Senate.

Section 3.7. Vice-President Of Academic Affairs

The Vice-President of Academic Affairs shall have the responsibility to oversee the activities of all standing and ad-hoc committees of the Senate tasked with improving the Institute's academics.

176 The Vice-President of Academic Affairs shall have the responsibility to act as a liaison
177 between the SGA and the Institute's faculty.

178 The Vice-President of Academic Affairs shall attend, or send in place a representative
179 to, meetings of the Faculty Senate and the Student Advisory Board.

180 **Section 3.8. Vice-President of Finance**

181 The Vice-President of Finance shall have the responsibility to act as a liaison between
182 the SGA, Office of Student Life, and Office of Finance regarding any financial issues
183 surrounding the SGA or Recognized Student Organizations.

184 The Vice-President of Finance shall have the responsibility to manage all financial
185 transactions and records of the SGA.

186 The Vice-President of Finance shall have the responsibility to act as the chair of the
187 Senate Budget Committee.

188 The Vice-President of Finance shall have the responsibility to oversee all expenditures
189 made by standing and ad-hoc committees of the Senate.

190 **Section 3.9. Vice-President of Student Interests**

191 The Vice-President of Student Interests shall have the responsibility to act as the chair
192 of the Committee on Student Interests.

193 The Vice-President of Student Interests shall have the responsibility to act as the
194 liaison between all Recognized Student Organizations and the SGA.

195 The Vice-President of Student Interests shall have the responsibility to aid in the
196 formation of new Recognized Student Organizations.

197 **Section 3.10. Vice-President of Relations**

198 The Vice-President of Relations shall have the responsibility to act as the liaison between
199 alumni, external partners, and the SGA. The Vice-President of Relations shall have the
200 responsibility to oversee the activities of all standing and ad hoc committees tasked with
201 improving alumni and external relations. The Vice-President of Relations shall be, or
202 seek election to be, a Student Leader Representative on the Stevens Alumni Association
203 Board of Directors. The Vice-President of Relations shall have the responsibility to
204 maintain an active relationship with all Young Alumni Trustees. The Vice-President of
205 Relations shall oversee the SGA's gift account and fundraising activities associated while
206 consulting the Vice-President of Finance, and aid Recognized Student Organizations in
207 the creation and stewardship of their respective gift accounts.

Section 3.11. Secretary

The Secretary shall have the responsibility to record minutes of all meetings of the Senate and the Cabinet.

The Secretary shall have the responsibility to act as the chair of the Election Committee, which shall serve to verify the results of all Senate and Presidential elections. In cases where the Secretary seeks election to the position of President, Vice-President of Operations, or Senator, or is promised an appointed Cabinet position, the Senate shall elect another Official of the SGA to chair the Election Committee in their place using secret ballot and a plurality voting system.

Article IV. Oversight/Impeachment

Section 4.1. Oversight Committee

There shall be an Oversight Committee responsible for the oversight of all Officials of the SGA. The Oversight Committee shall consist of the Speaker, who shall act as the chair and the number of seats on the committee shall be contingent on the proportion of Senators currently within the SGA with one seat for every ten (10) senators while following standard rounding rules. All seats shall be “at-Large” allowing all Senators an equal chance to be elected to a seat. Voting shall be done through a secret ballot and using a ranked choice voting system.

Section 4.2. Initial Proceedings & Disciplinary Actions

Any Official of the SGA may bring concerns to the Oversight Committee in regards to any other Official of the SGA who may be in breach of the governing documents of the SGA. The aforementioned Official of the SGA must receive a written reply from the Oversight Committee acknowledging that their concerns have been heard. The members of Oversight Committee shall view evidence against the accused Official at the next Oversight Committee Meeting. Should the latter be impeached, then the Oversight Committee shall, with a two-thirds majority vote, debate upon one of the following disciplinary actions:

1. Request to Resign

- a) The Oversight Committee shall request via Email that the accused Official resigns from the SGA at the earliest available opportunity.
- b) Should the Official not wish to resign, then they shall follow the procedure outlined in the next listed disciplinary action.
- c) If the Official does not respond to the Email acknowledging that they have seen the Email within 48 hours, then they shall be removed from office

2. Warning/Clarification of Role

- a) The Oversight Committee shall request via Email that the accused Official provides, in written notice, acknowledgment of breaching the government documents of the SGA to all Officials of the SGA along with a notice of how they shall improve themselves.

b) Upon deliberation by the Oversight Committee after they have received the letter at the next Oversight Committee meeting, the Oversight Committee shall either drop all charges, strip the Official of any special title, or remove the Official from the SGA. Special titles include appointed committee chairs and elected committee membership.

c) If the Official does not respond to the Email within 48 hours acknowledging that they have seen the Email, then they shall be removed from office.

3. Removal from Office

a) The accused Official shall be removed from office. Removal from Office removes an Official of the SGA from their Official position(s). This disciplinary action is effective immediately.

4. Ban from the SGA

a) The accused Official shall be removed from their current position and shall be prohibited from holding Office in the SGA ever again. This disciplinary action shall be effective immediately and last forever.

If the accused Official is a member of the Oversight Committee, then the latter Oversight Committee member shall not have a vote. The chair must appoint another Senator of that member's school as a pro tem member to vote on that member's disciplinary action. If the accused Official is the Speaker, then the Vice President of Operations shall serve as acting chair of the committee while the Oversight Committee deliberates on a disciplinary action. In this circumstance, the Vice President of Operations may break a tie if the vote to adopt a disciplinary action is divided.

Section 4.3. Impeachment Proceedings

The Oversight Committee shall impeach an Official by adopting the motion "I move to impeach ["Name"]." The motion to impeach shall have the following characteristics:

1. It can be made only by a member of the Oversight Committee at an Oversight Committee meeting.

2. It can be made only on an Official of the SGA.

a) If a member of the Oversight Committee moves to impeach another member of the Oversight Committee, then the latter Oversight Committee member shall not have a vote. The chair must appoint another Senator of that member's school as a pro tem member to vote on that member's impeachment.

b) If a member of the Oversight Committee moves to impeach the Speaker, then:

i. The Vice President of Operations shall serve as acting chair of the committee while this motion to impeachment is debated.

282 ii. The Vice President of Operations shall break a tie if the vote on the
283 motion to impeach is divided.

284 3. It shall not require a second.

285 4. It shall not be amendable.

286 5. It shall be debatable.

287 6. Adoption of this motion shall require a two-thirds majority.

288 Upon completion of the vote, the Oversight Committee impeaches the Official by
289 charging them with breaching the governing documents of the SGA.

290 **Section 4.4. Appeal Impeachment Trial**

291 An Official of the SGA who has been impeached may appeal the decision of the Over-
292 sight Committee by trial before the Senate within 48 hours of being notified of their
293 impeachment. The Official must write a formal letter and deliver it to the Speaker and
294 VPO entailing their new goals and how they hope to contribute to the SGA or reasoning
295 as to why they believe their impeachment and/or disciplinary action was not warranted
296 within 48 hours of appealing the decision of the Oversight Committee. Once the letter
297 has been delivered, the Secretary shall include “Impeachment Appeal of [“Name”]” on
298 the agenda for the next Senate meeting. If the letter is delivered within 48 hours of the
299 next Senate meeting, then the Appeal Impeachment shall take place during the following
300 Senate meeting. At the Senate meeting, a motion will be made to discuss the Impeach-
301 ment Appeal in this format “I move to vote on the Impeachment Appeal of [“Name”]”.
302 This motion shall have the following characteristics:

303 1. It shall require a second.

304 2. It shall not be amendable.

305 3. It shall be debatable.

306 4. Adoption of this motion shall require a simple majority.

307 5. Voting will be conducted via a closed form.

308 The results of the vote shall be effective immediately. Should the Senate approve the
309 Impeachment Appeal, then all Disciplinary Actions levied by the Oversight Committee
310 on the affected individual will be null.

Article V. Recognized Student Organizations

Section 5.1. Definition

A Recognized Student Organization is any organization with non-exclusive membership granted that status by the Senate or any previously existing system of student governance.

Section 5.2. Policies

Every Recognized Student Organization must have an executive board, or another similarly named board, composed of officers elected by the organization for a term of no more than one year or until their successors are elected. Recognized Student Organizations may also choose to have officers who are not members of an executive board. Officers of a Recognized Student Organization shall not be considered Officials of the SGA.

No Recognized Student Organization may preclude any member of the Student Body from being eligible for membership. No Recognized Student Organization may preclude any member of the Student Body from participating in its events or activities, except by means of audition or fair contest for a role. No Recognized Student Organization may require a student to participate in its activities or otherwise remain affiliated with the organization.

Recognized Student Organizations must cooperate in investigations of their activity brought forth by the SGA.

Article VI. Elections

There shall be an Election Committee responsible for administering all active elections for the President, Vice-President of Operations, and Senate of the SGA. The committee is responsible for determining, prior to the start of the Fall semester, the timeframe when individuals who seek a position, herein referred to as “Candidates”, are to submit an intention to run in an upcoming election to the Secretary, herein defined as the “Nomination Period”, and the timeframe when members of the Student Body may cast votes, herein referred to as the “Voting Period” for all elections of the SGA. The committee shall also ensure all Candidates follow the Election Rules defined in Section 6.6. of the SGA Constitution.

Section 6.1. Senator Elections

Once per academic year, a General Election of the Senate will be held within the month of September. The Election Committee shall announce election dates, nomination periods, and event schedules to the Senate. All members of the Student Body shall be notified of the Nomination Period and Voting Period for a General Election of the Senate prior to the start of the Fall semester.

During the General Election, all active Senators shall need to win a seat or be vacated from their seats at the start of the new Senate Session.

The General Election period shall last for 2 weeks. The first week shall be dedicated to the Nomination Period whereas the second week shall be dedicated to the Voting Period, during which ballots for the “by-School” seats will be accepted.

Candidates must submit their intention to run to the Secretary during the Nomination Period. Candidates are eligible to run for only one “by-School” seat, designated at the time of submitting their intention to run. At the conclusion of the Nomination Period, the Election Committee shall, in conjunction with the Office of Student Life, have up to 2 days to determine if the Candidates meet the eligibility requirements to be a Senator as defined by Institute policy or established by resolution of the Senate. This verification period shall not count toward the 2-week election period.

Once the eligibility for all Candidates has been verified, the Voting Period shall commence. Senators from each school shall be elected by secret ballot by the students in that School using a plurality at-large voting system. Candidates may receive votes only from undergraduate students in the same School as the Candidate. All Candidates are required to obtain 2.5% of the votes from undergraduate members of their School. Any Candidate who fails to meet this requirement will not be allowed election to the Senate during the General Election. During the Voting Period, Candidates cannot change their

selected “by-School” seat.

If there are more Candidates running than the number of “by-School” seats for their specific school are available, the Candidates, given they meet the number of nominations required, may still compete for an “At-Large” seat during this same election cycle. Any seats left vacant will be designated as “At-Large” seats and will be elected alongside the initially defined “At-Large” seats through Senator Vacancy Elections. If a “by-School” or “At-Large” seat has only one candidate running, the Candidate will automatically be elected unless the “Reopen Nominations” option receives more votes than the candidate. If any Candidate receives less votes than the “Reopen Nominations”, they shall not be elected.

At the conclusion of the Voting Period, the Election results must be certified by the Election Committee Chair, after which the results must be announced within 2 days.

Section 6.2. Senator Vacancy Elections

In the event of a Senator’s resignation or a vacancy of a Senate seat, a vacancy election must be held no later than two weeks after. All Senate seats elected through a vacancy shall be considered “At-Large” seats. If there have been 2 separate vacancy elections, then in the event of at least 10% of Senate seats being vacant, a Senator Vacancy Election must be held. The Election Committee may call additional Senator Vacancy Elections with a two-thirds affirmative vote of the Election Committee. Once a Senator Vacancy Election is called, the Election Committee must host a campaign to promote the election to the Student Body.

Once the Election Committee recognizes the need for a vacancy election, the election process must begin within one week.

Senator Vacancy Elections shall last one week. The first three days shall be dedicated to the Nomination Period, whereas the remainder of the time will be dedicated to Candidates gathering fifty votes from members of the Student Body. Candidates shall be elected by secret ballot using a plurality at-large voting system.

After the Nomination Period closes, the Secretary, in conjunction with the Office of Student Life, shall have up to two days to determine if the Candidates meet the eligibility requirements to be a Senator as defined by Institute policy or established by resolution of the Senate. This verification period shall not count toward the 1-week election period.

The certification of the election results by the Election Committee Chair shall take place immediately after and last for no more than two days.

If a Senator Vacancy Election is to be held when the Senate is “in reduced session”, the Senator Vacancy Election procedure must commence once the Senate is “in session”.

If there is only one Candidate running for a vacant seat, the Candidate will automatically be elected unless the “Reopen Nominations” option receives more votes than the candidate. If any Candidate receives less votes than the “Reopen Nominations” option, they shall not be elected.

Section 6.3. Tied Senator Elections

If two or more Candidates receive an equal number of votes for any vacant Senate seat, the Election Committee shall have a meeting with the tied Candidates and nominate a Candidate to the position by a two-thirds affirmative vote. This vote must be held by a closed ballot.

Section 6.4. Presidential Elections

The President and Vice-President of Operations shall be elected together on a single ticket by the Student Body using secret ballot and a plurality voting system. A Presidential Election shall occur once per academic year following the conclusion of the General Election.

The election period shall last two weeks. The first week is the Nomination Period, where all Candidates must gather signatures from 5% of the Student Body to be considered eligible for the next step. All signatures must be on paper form. At the conclusion of the Nomination Period, the Election Committee Chair, in conjunction with the Office of Student Life, shall have up to five days to determine if the Candidates meet the eligibility requirements to be President as defined by Institute policy or established by resolution of the Senate. Afterwards, all Candidates are required to attend a Nomination Verification Meeting with the Election Committee to discuss election rules, ethical guidelines, responsibilities, and campaign materials. This verification period shall not count toward the 2-week election period.

The second week of Presidential Elections shall be dedicated to the Voting Period where Candidates must collect votes from members of the Student Body. Each eligible member of the Student Body may only cast one vote total during the Presidential Election. If there is only one individual running, they shall only win the election pending they receive more votes than the “Reopen Nominations” option. Should “Reopen Nominations” receive more votes than all candidates, the Election Committee will be responsible for setting up another election period within three days.

At the conclusion of the Voting Period, the Election Committee Chair and the SGA Advisor shall have up to five days to certify the results of the election. The winner of the election shall be announced at the next available Senate meeting and then to the Student Body the next day.

During the Voting Period, the Election Committee, in conjunction with the Office of Student Life, shall be responsible for setting up a:

1. Presidential Debate: A mandatory debate shall be held before the end of the voting period, allowing candidates to present their platforms to the student body. The SGA Advisor will moderate the debate unless determined otherwise by the Election Committee.
2. Vice Presidential Debate: A mandatory debate shall be held before the end of the voting period, allowing candidate perspective for the specific body. The SGA

Advisor will moderate the debate unless determined otherwise by the Election Committee.

3. Meet the Candidates: A mandatory event with the purpose of the student body meeting all the candidates.

4. Any and all other events deemed necessary by the Election Committee

These events shall be open to everyone in the Student Body. All candidates are required to attend any event deemed necessary by the Election Committee. In the case of a tie between the tickets which receive the greatest number of votes, the Senate shall choose from among those tickets using secret ballot and a plurality voting system.

Section 6.5. Conflict of Interest

Should a member of the Student Body choose to become a Candidate in any SGA election or be tapped for appointment to any Candidate's Cabinet, they shall not be eligible for membership on the Election Committee or to chair it.

Section 6.6. Election Rules

There will always be the specified option to "Reopen Nominations" during the Voting Period for all elections, unless otherwise noted.

Only members of the Student Body in good standing with the Institute may vote in an election. Each eligible member of the Student Body may only cast one vote per Candidate but may vote for as many Candidates as they want unless otherwise noted.

Individuals reserve the right to serve as Candidates in multiple elections. All Candidates who run for a position and are not elected shall remain eligible for all upcoming elections provided they meet all other requirements.

All Candidates are granted permission to use Campaign Materials, or items, both digitally and physically, that may help to promote themselves to the Student Body. No Campaign Materials for Presidential Elections may be posted until the Election Committee holds a Nomination Verification Meeting. Candidates shall be given a Campaign Budget, determined by the Election Committee prior to the start of the Fall semester, which they shall not exceed. All campaigning must be studentrun; no faculty, staff, or external organizations may assist with campaign materials, finances, or endorsements.

All Campaign Materials, physical or digital, must be approved by the Election Committee via a majority vote prior to their distribution. Any physical Campaign Materials must be removed within 24 hours after the conclusion of the elections Voting Period.

All physical and digital Campaign Materials must follow SGA and Institute ethical guidelines. Candidates must also adhere to the Institute's posting and digital communication guidelines. No campaigning by any individual may be done using Institute systems unless granted explicit permission by the Election Committee and Office of Student Life. Social media, ads, posts, and endorsements will always be conducted through

personal accounts. Mass emailing through Institute systems is prohibited unless explicitly allowed by the Election Committee Chair and the SGA Advisor.

SGA resources, including email lists, meeting spaces, official SGA social media accounts, and financial accounts, may not be used for campaigning. The use of any SGA resources must be explicitly approved by the Election Committee and the Treasurer. Candidates must submit a formal request for any intended SGA resource use, and approval must be documented in writing by the Election Committee Chair.

No Candidate may engage in slandering of their opponent, nor may they engage in coercion, intimidation, bribery, or voter suppression.

Candidates must meet eligibility criteria as set by SGA Guidelines, which include but are not limited to:

1. Maintaining a minimum GPA as determined by SGA policy.
2. Being enrolled as a full-time student at the Institute.
3. Not being on academic or disciplinary probation at the time of candidacy declaration.
4. Meeting any additional criteria set forth by the SGA Constitution or Bylaws.

These rules are applicable to the General Election of the Senate, Senator Vacancy Elections, and Presidential Elections unless otherwise specified above.

Section 6.7. Violations and Enforcement

Violation of campaign rules or election integrity as described in Section 6.6. of the SGA Constitution must be reviewed by the Election Committee. Should the Election Committee determine with a majority affirmative vote that a violation of the rules occurred, they shall contact the SGA Advisor and work with them to classify the violation as either Minor or Severe and impose appropriate repercussions.

Should a violation be determined as Minor, the Election Committee shall have the authority to send a warning to the Candidate responsible, suspend the Candidate's Campaign Materials — both digital and physical —, require the Candidate to submit an apology letter to the SGA, or another punishment as determined by the Election Committee Chair and the SGA Advisor.

Should an infraction be determined as Severe, the Election Committee shall have the authority to disqualify the Candidate from the election, ban the Candidate from running in all future SGA elections, suspend them from holding any Executive Board position in any recognized student organization, pending approval from the SGA Advisor, or another punishment as determined by the Election Committee Chair and the SGA Advisor.

515 **Article VII. Bylaws**

516 The Bylaws of the Student Government Association shall dictate the procedures for and
517 the regulation of affairs of the SGA and shall be valid for all intents and purposes of this
518 constitution.

519 No bylaw shall supersede or be inconsistent with this constitution. No procedure
520 or legislation shall supersede any existing bylaws, excluding temporary suspension of
521 bylaws and new bylaws. A new bylaw shall be introduced in the form of a bill.

Article VIII. Amendment of this Constitution

The SGA shall open a secret ballot referendum for the ratification of any proposed amendment of this constitution within one week of receipt by an Official of the SGA a petition bearing the signatures of ten percent of the students of each Class or initiative of the SGA itself. These referendums shall remain open for a period of thirty-one (31) days.

Amendment of this constitution shall become effective by way of a two-thirds affirmative vote of the undergraduate students voting, with a voting quorum of five percent of the Student Body.

Article IX. Adoption

This constitution shall become effective upon ratification by the Student Body by way of a secret ballot referendum as specified in Article VIII and approval by the Office of Student Life.

The establishment of this constitution shall abolish any previously existing constitution for the governance of the Student Body. The Student Body shall be hereby bound by this constitution and all rules and regulations brought into effect by its powers.